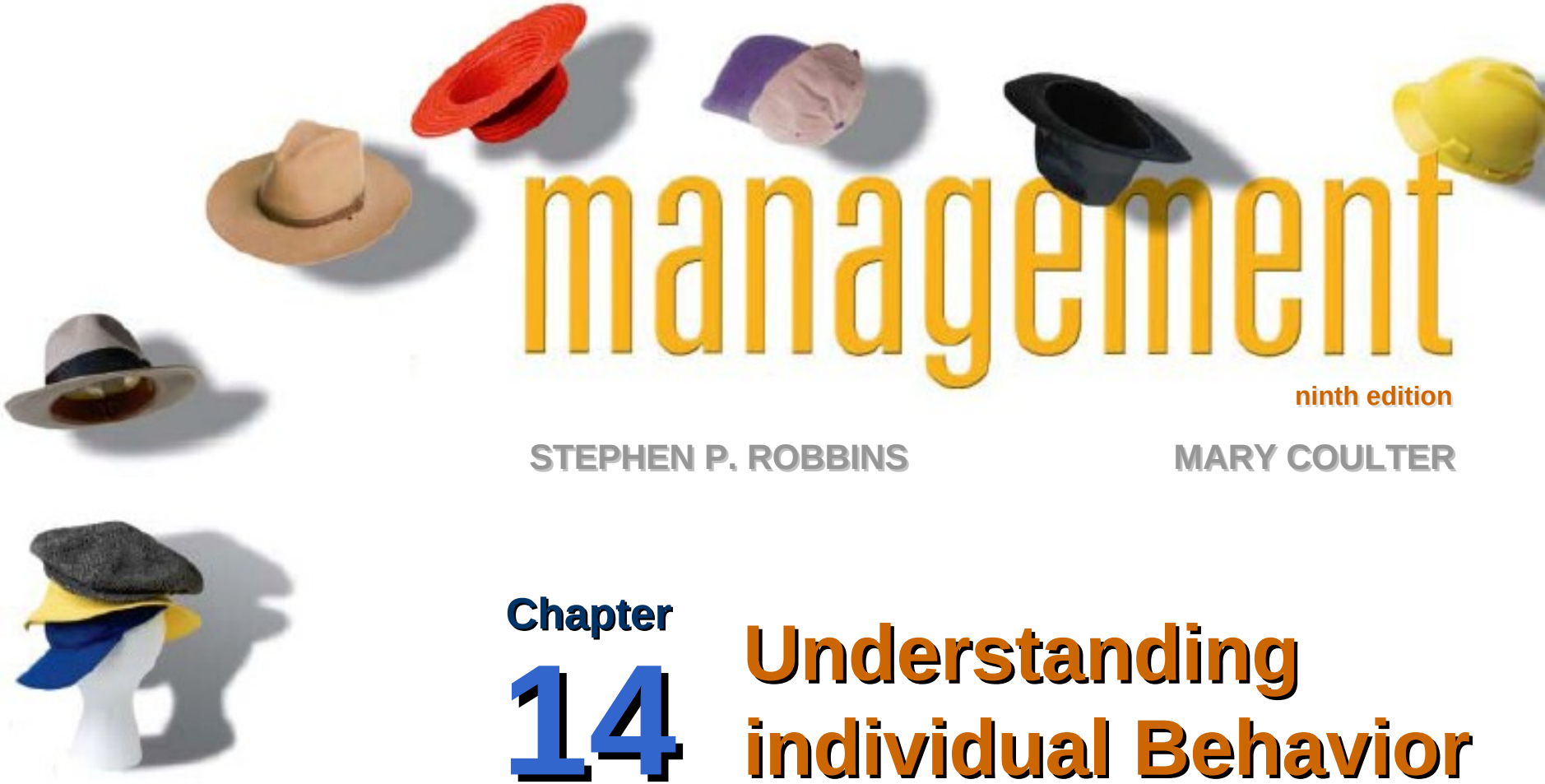

management

ninth edition

STEPHEN P. ROBBINS MARY COULTER

Chapter

14 Understanding individual Behavior

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PowerPoint Presentation by Charlie Cook
The University of West Alabama

LEARNING OUTLINE

Follow this Learning Outline as you read and study this chapter.

Why Look at Individual Behavior?

- Explain why the concept of an organization as an iceberg is important to understanding organizational behavior.
- Describe the focus and the goals of organizational behavior.
- Define the six important employee behaviors that managers want to explain, predict, and influence.

Attitudes

- Describe the three components of an attitude.
- Discuss three job-related attitudes.
- Describe the impact job satisfaction has on employee behavior.

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LEARNING OUTLINE (cont'd)

Follow this Learning Outline as you read and study this chapter.

Attitudes (cont'd)

- Explain how individuals reconcile inconsistencies between attitudes and behavior.

•Personality

- Contrast the MBTI and the big-five model of personality.
- Describe the five personality traits that have proved to be most powerful in explaining individual behavior in organizations.
- Explain how emotions and emotional intelligence impact behavior.

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LEARNING OUTLINE (cont'd)

Follow this Learning Outline as you read and study this chapter.

Perception

- Explain how an understanding of perception can help managers.
- Describe the key elements of attribution theory.
- Discuss how the fundamental attribution error and self-serving bias can distort attributions.
- Name three shortcuts used in judging others.

Learning

- Explain how operant conditioning helps managers understand, predict, and influence behavior.
- Describe the implications of social learning theory for managing people at work.

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LEARNING OUTLINE (cont'd)

Follow this Learning Outline as you read and study this chapter.

Learning (cont'd)

- Discuss how managers can shape behavior.

Contemporary OB Issues

- Describe the challenges managers face in managing Gen Y workers.
- Explain what managers can do to deal with workplace misbehavior.

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Self-Awareness: You Need to Know Yourself Before You Can Know Others

- To grow and succeed, we need to also understand our **strengths** *and* **weaknesses**

Knowing yourself helps you:

- Improve where needed
- Understand how others see you
- Make better choices in life and work

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🔑 5 Key Parts of Your Personality

- **1. Introversion vs. Extraversion**

Introverts: Like quiet, deep thinking, and working alone.

Extraverts: Like being around people, action, and variety.

- **2. Thinking vs. Feeling**

Thinkers: Make decisions with logic and facts.

Feelers: Make decisions based on emotions and values.

- **3. Internal vs. External Control**

Internal control: You believe you shape your own future.

External control: You think outside forces (luck, fate) control your life.

- **4. Organized vs. Disorganized**

Organized: Reliable, responsible, meet deadlines.

Disorganized: Easily distracted, often late or unprepared.

- **5. Open to Change vs. Comfortable with the Familiar**

Open to change: Curious, creative, like new things.

Comfortable with the familiar: Like routine and dislike change.

- 🧠 **Important:** There's no "right" or "wrong" personality. Each style has good and bad sides. What matters is **knowing who you are** and **where you fit best**.

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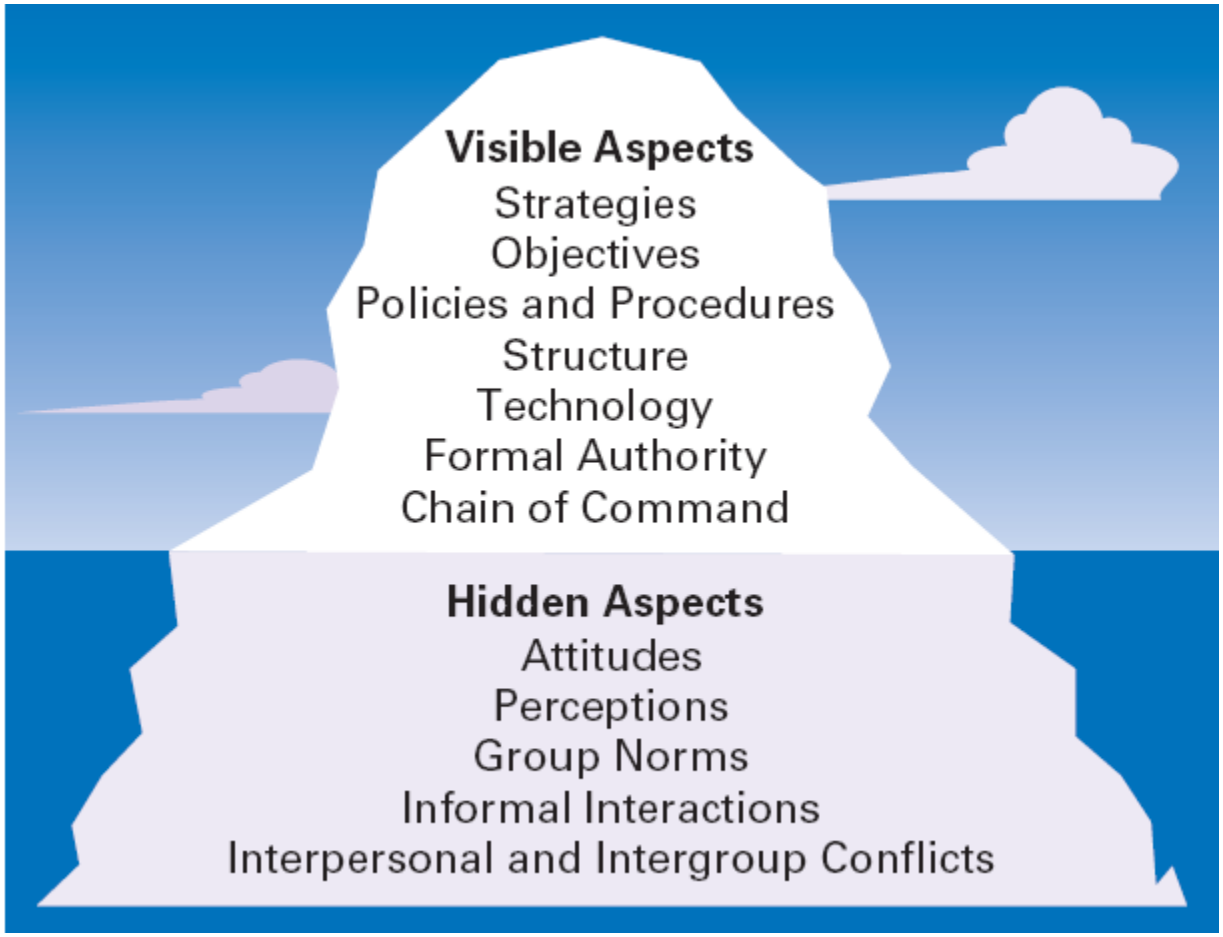
Exhibit 14.1 The Organization as an Iceberg



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Example: Market Basket Protest

More than **25,000 employees** at **Market Basket**, a family-owned supermarket in New England, **protested for two months** after their CEO, **Arthur T. Demoulas**, was fired because of a fight with his cousin, **Arthur S. Demoulas**.

Arthur T. was a **well-liked leader**. He:

- Paid employees **more than average**
- **Promoted** from within the company
- **Clearly communicated** with his workers

Because of this, employees were **very loyal** to him.

When he was fired:

- Workers protested
- Customers and suppliers **joined the boycott**
- The company lost **around $70 million each day**

Eventually, the pressure forced the company to **bring Arthur T. back** as CEO.

Arthur S. learned the hard way how powerful the **hidden behaviors** and **emotions** in a company can be — even if everything looks fine on the surface.

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Why Look at Individual Behavior?

- Behavior:

  "The actions of people"
- Organizational Behavior (OB)

  "The study of the actions of people at work"
- Focus of Organizational Behavior
  - Individual behavior
    - Attitudes, personality, perception, learning, and motivation
  - Group behavior
    - Norms, roles, team building, leadership, and conflict
- Goals of Organizational Behavior
  - To explain, predict and influence behavior.

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Goals of Organizational Behavior

- OB helps **managers understand people at work**. It has three main goals:

1. **Explain behavior** – Why do employees act a certain way?
2. **Predict behavior** – How will employees react to a decision or change?
3. **Influence behavior** – How can we guide employees to act in positive ways?

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What employee behaviors are managers most concerned about?

- There are **six important employee behaviors** that OB focuses on:

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Important Employee Behaviors

- Employee Productivity
  - A performance measure of both efficiency and effectiveness
- Absenteeism
  - Failure to show up for work
- Turnover
  - The voluntary and involuntary permanent withdrawal from an organization

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Important Employee Behaviors (cont'd)

- Organizational Citizenship Behavior (OCB)
  - Discretionary behavior that is not a part of an employee's formal job requirements, but which promotes the effective functioning of the organization.
  - Examples: Helping teammates, volunteering, staying positive, and avoiding conflict.
  - Companies with good OCB often perform **better**.
  - But too much of it can cause **stress** or **burnout**.
- Job Satisfaction
  - The individual's general attitude toward his or her job

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Important Employee Behaviors (cont'd)

- Workplace Misbehavior
  - Any intentional employee behavior that has negative consequences for the organization or individuals within the organization.
  - Types of Misbehavior
    - Deviance
    - Aggression
    - Breaking rules
    - Violence

These behaviors can **damage** the workplace and **hurt other employees**.

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Psychological Factors Affecting Employee Behavior

- Attitudes
- Personality
- Perception
- Learning

- Employee Productivity
- Absenteeism
- Turnover
- Organizational Citizenship
- Job Satisfaction
- Workplace Misbehavior

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Psychological Factors

- Attitudes
  - Evaluative statements—either favorable or unfavorable—concerning objects, people, or events.
- When a person says, “I like my job,” he or she is expressing an attitude about work.
- An attitude is made up of three components
- Components Of An Attitude
  - **Cognitive component:** the beliefs, opinions, knowledge, or information held by a person(for instance, the belief that “discrimination is wrong”)
  - **Affective component:** the emotional or feeling part of an attitude.

    “I feel upset and angry when I see someone being treated unfairly.”
  - **Behavioral component:** the intention to behave in a certain way.” I might choose to avoid Pat because of my feelings about him.”

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Psychological Factors (cont'd)

- Job Satisfaction
  - Job satisfaction is affected by level of income earned and by the type of job a worker does.
- Job Satisfaction and Productivity
  - For individuals, productivity appears to lead to job satisfaction.
  - For organizations, those with more satisfied employees are more effective than those with less satisfied employees.

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Psychological Factors (cont'd)

- Job Satisfaction and Absenteeism
  - Satisfied employees tend to have lower levels of absenteeism.
- Job Satisfaction and Turnover
  - Satisfied employees have lower levels of turnover; dissatisfied employees have higher levels of turnover.
  - Turnover is affected by the level of employee performance.
    - The preferential treatment afforded superior employees makes satisfaction less important in predicting their turnover decisions.

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🔑 Job Satisfaction & Retaining Top Performers

Top performers are less likely to quit, even if job satisfaction is low.

- 📈 Companies try hard to **keep them** with:
- Pay raises
- Praise
- Promotions

✅ How Managers Can Boost Job Satisfaction

🎯 Identify **incentives** employees truly value.

- 💡 **Example:**
- *Darius Fisher*, President of Status Labs
- Rewards for meeting sales goals include:
  - 🎟️ Festival passes
  - ⌚ Apple Watches
  - 🧼 Home cleaning services
- 💰 While these seem expensive, they are **cheaper than losing and replacing employees**.

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Psychological Factors (cont'd)

- Job Satisfaction and Customer Satisfaction
  - The level of job satisfaction for frontline employees is related to increased customer satisfaction and loyalty.
  - Interaction with dissatisfied customers can increase an employee's job dissatisfaction.
  - Actions to increase job satisfaction for customer service workers:
    - Hire upbeat and friendly employees.
    - Reward superior customer service.
    - Provide a positive work climate.
    - Use attitude surveys to track employee satisfaction.

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Psychological Factors (cont'd)

- Job Satisfaction and Workplace Misbehavior
  - Dissatisfied employees will respond somehow
  - Not easy to predict exactly how they'll respond

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Psychological Factors (cont'd)

- Job Involvement
  - The degree to which an employee identifies with his or her job, actively participates in it, and considers his or her performance to be important to his or her self-worth.
  - Job involvement means **how much a person cares about their job**, and how much they see it as a **part of who they are**.
    - High levels of commitment are related to fewer absences and lower resignation rates.
  - ✅ Example:
  - Rita is a nurse who truly loves helping people. She:
  - Stays late if a patient needs extra care
  - Feels proud when she does her job well
  - Thinks her work is a big part of who she is
  - 👉 Rita has high job involvement.

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Psychological Factors (cont'd)

- Organizational Commitment
  - Is the degree to which an employee identifies with a particular organization and its goals and wishes to maintain membership in the organization.
  - Organizational commitment means **how much an employee connects with the company**, supports its goals, and **wants to stay** with the company.
  - Leads to lower levels of both absenteeism and turnover.
  - Could be becoming an outmoded measure as the number of workers who change employers increases.

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Organizational Commitment

- ✅ **Example:**
- **John** works at a tech company. He believes:
- The company **cares about him**
- His work is **appreciated**
- He **agrees with the company's goals**
- 👉 Even if his current project isn't perfect, he wants to **stay with the company**.
  That's **organizational commitment**.

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Psychological Factors (cont'd)

- Perceived Organizational Support
  - Is the general belief of employees that their organization values their contribution and cares about their well-being.
  - Represents the commitment of the organization to the employee.
  - Providing high levels of support increases job satisfaction and lower turnover.

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Attitudes and Consistency

- People like to be consistent — they want their thoughts, beliefs, and actions to match. When something doesn't match (called inconsistency), it can make them feel uncomfortable or confused. To fix that feeling, they often change their attitude, change their behavior, or make excuses to explain the difference.
- People seek consistency in two ways:
  - Consistency among their attitudes.
  - Consistency between their attitudes and behaviors.
- If an inconsistency arises, individuals:
  - Alter their attitudes
  - Alter their behavior
  - Develop a rationalization for the inconsistency

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Attitudes and Consistency

Example : The campus recruiter

- Recruiter works for a company (**Enterprise Rent-a-Car**) and travels to colleges to tell students it's a great place to work. But privately, he thinks the company is actually not great due poor working conditions and few opportunities for promotion.
- This mismatch between what he says and what he believes creates discomfort. To deal with it, he might:

1. **Change his belief**: Start to believe the company is good, because he keeps saying it is.
2. **Change his behavior**: Stop talking positively about the company, or even start criticizing it.
3. **Rationalize**: Say to himself, "My job is just to promote the good parts — no company is perfect."

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Cognitive Dissonance Theory

- Any incompatibility or inconsistency between attitudes or between behavior and attitudes.
  - Any form of inconsistency is uncomfortable and individuals will try to reduce the dissonance.
  - Dissonance = conflict, tension, or inconsistency between ideas, beliefs, or actions.
- Cognitive dissonance is the mental discomfort we feel when we hold two conflicting beliefs, values, or behaviors.
- Example: If someone believes smoking is bad but continues to smoke, they experience dissonance between their belief and behavior. They may try to reduce it by changing their behavior (quitting) or justifying it (“It helps me relax”).

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Factors influencing the intensity of dissonance

1. The importance of the factors creating the dissonance.

- The more important the belief or issue, the stronger the discomfort.
- Example: Dissonance about health (important) feels stronger than dissonance about choosing a brand (less important).

2. The degree to which an individual believes that the factors causing the dissonance are controllable. If Ravi feels he *can* quit smoking but doesn't, dissonance increases.

If he feels *addicted* and unable to quit, dissonance is reduced.

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Factors influencing the intensity of dissonance cont……

- 3. Rewards available to compensate for the dissonance.
- Large rewards or external justifications can reduce dissonance.
- Example: If Ravi smokes because his job involves tobacco testing and he’s paid well, the reward may compensate for the dissonance.

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Attitude Surveys

- Attitude Surveys
  - A instrument/document that presents employees with a set of statements or questions eliciting how they feel about their jobs, work groups, supervisors, or their organization.
  - Provide management with feedback on employee perceptions of the organization and their jobs.

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Exhibit 14.2 Sample Attitude Survey

Please answer each of the following statements using the following rating scale:
5 = Strongly agree
4 = Agree
3 = Undecided
2 = Disagree
1 = Strongly disagree

Statement	Rating
1. This company is a pretty good place to work.	_____
2. I can get ahead in this company if I make the effort.	_____
3. This company's wage rates are competitive with those of other companies.	_____
4. Employee promotion decisions are handled fairly.	_____
5. I understand the various fringe benefits the company offers.	_____
6. My job makes the best use of my abilities.	_____
7. My workload is challenging but not burdensome.	_____
8. I have trust and confidence in my boss.	_____
9. I feel free to tell my boss what I think.	_____
10. I know what my boss expects of me.	_____

Source: Based on T. Lammers, "The Essential Employee Survey," *Inc*., December 1992, pp. 159–161.

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The Importance of Attitudes

- Implication for Managers
  - Managers should be interested in their employees' attitudes because they influence behavior.
    - Satisfied and committed employees
    - for instance:Lower rates of turnover and absenteeism especially among their more productive employees
    - Managers should do things that generate the positive attitudes that reduce absenteeism and turnover.

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The Importance of Attitudes

- Implication for Managers
  - Attitudes influence behaviors of employees:
  - Managers should focus on helping employees become more productive to increase job satisfaction. managers should focus on those factors that have been shown to be conducive to high levels of employee job satisfaction:
  - making work challenging and
  - interesting, providing equitable rewards,
  - creating supportive working conditions, and
  - encouraging supportive colleagues.

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The Importance of Attitudes

- Implication for Managers
  - Managers should also survey (useful pieces of information an organization) employees about their attitudes
  - Employees will try to reduce dissonance: when employees must do something that conflicts with their values or attitudes, Managers should help reduce this dissonance.
  - **Example: An** employee believes in quality but is asked to speed up production, reducing quality standards. This creates dissonance the employee feels uneasy doing something they disagree with.

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The Importance of Attitudes

- Managers identify the external sources of dissonance forces such as competitors, customers, or other factors

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Personality

- Personality
  - The unique combination of psychological characteristics (measurable traits) that affect how a person reacts and interacts with others.
  - *terms such as quiet, passive, loud, aggressive, ambitious, extraverted, loyal, tense, or sociable,*

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Classifying Personality Traits

- Myers Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI®)
  - A general personality assessment tool that measures the personality of an individual using four categories:
    - Social interaction: Extrovert or Introvert (E or I)
    - Preference for gathering data: Sensing or Intuitive (S or N)
    - Preference for decision making: Feeling or Thinking (F or T)
    - Style of decision making: Perceptive or Judgmental (P or J)
  - The MBTI helps classify people into 16 personality types based on how they interact with others (E–I), gather information (S–N), make decisions (T–F), and deal with the external world (J–P).
    It's useful for understanding differences at work — not for judging who is "better," but for helping managers build balanced and effective teams.

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The Four MBTI Dimensions

- **1. Extraversion (E) vs. Introversion (I)**
- **Extraverts (E):** Outgoing, talkative, sociable, energized by people and action.
  → Prefer team projects, meetings, and dynamic workplaces.
- **Introverts (I):** Quiet, reflective, prefer solitary or small-group settings.
  → Prefer independent work and calm, structured environments.
- **Example:**
- *An extraverted salesperson* loves attending client meetings and networking events.
- *An introverted researcher* enjoys focusing on data analysis in a quiet lab.

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The Four MBTI Dimensions cont…..

- **2. Sensing (S) vs. Intuition (N)**
- **Sensing (S):** Practical, detail-oriented, prefer facts and routines.
  → Good at step-by-step tasks and following established procedures.
- **Intuition (N):** Imaginative, big-picture thinkers, prefer innovation and ideas.
  → Good at strategy, innovation, and solving new problems.
- **Example:**
- *A sensing engineer* prefers working with detailed blueprints and proven designs.
- *An intuitive designer* loves brainstorming new product ideas without strict rules.

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The Four MBTI Dimensions cont……

3.Thinking (T) vs. Feeling (F)

- **Thinking (T):** Logical, analytical, value fairness and objectivity.
→ Make decisions based on facts, not emotions.
- **Feeling (F):** Empathetic, value harmony and relationships.
→ Make decisions based on personal values and people's feelings.
- **Example:**
- *A thinking manager* decides promotions based purely on performance data.
- *A feeling manager* considers both performance and how the decision affects morale.

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The Four MBTI Dimensions cont……

- **4. Judging (J) vs. Perceiving (P)**
- **Judging (J):** Organized, structured, like planning and closure.
  → Prefer fixed schedules and clear deadlines.
- **Perceiving (P):** Flexible, spontaneous, like keeping options open.
  → Prefer adaptable environments with freedom and exploration.
- **Example:**
- *A judging project manager* makes detailed timelines and sticks to them.
- *A perceiving artist* likes to explore ideas freely and adapt as inspiration comes.

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Exhibit 14.3 Examples of MBTI® Types

Type	Description
I–S–F–P (introversion, sensing, feeling, perceiving)	Sensitive, kind, modest, shy, and quietly friendly. Such people strongly dislike disagreements and will avoid them. They are loyal followers and quite often are relaxed about getting things done.
E–N–T–J (extraversion, intuition, thinking, judging)	Warm, friendly, candid, and decisive; also skilled in anything that requires reasoning and intelligent talk, but may sometimes overestimate what they are capable of doing.

Source: Based on I. Briggs-Myers, *Introduction to Type* (Palo Alto, CA: Consulting Psychologists Press, 1980), pp. 7–8.

Exhibit 15-3

Examples of MBTI® Personality Types

Source: Based on I. Briggs-Myers, *Introduction to Type* (Palo Alto, CA: Consulting Psychologists Press, 1980), pp. 7–8.

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The Big-Five Model:

Personality trait model that includes

- **Extraversion**
  - Sociable, talkative, and assertive, comfortable in relationship with others
- **Agreeableness**
  - Good-natured, cooperative, and trusting
- **Conscientiousness**
- The degree to which someone is reliable, responsible, dependable, persistent, and achievement oriented
- **Emotional Stability**
  - The degree to which someone is calm, enthusiastic, and secure (positive) or tense, nervous, depressed, and insecure (negative).
- **Openness to Experience**
  - Imaginative, artistically
  - sensitive, and intellectual

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Relationship between traits and job performance

- Five categories of occupations: *professionals* (such as engineers, architects, and attorneys),*police, managers, salespeople*, and *semiskilled and skilled employees*
- **Conscientiousness** predicted job performance for all five occupational groups
- **Extraversion** predicted performance in managerial and sales positions—occupations in which high social interaction is necessary.
- **Openness to** relates to how well people learn during training.
- **Emotional security** wasn't positively related to job performance in any of the occupations.
- Employees who score higher in **conscientiousness** develop higher levels of job knowledge, probably because highly conscientious people learn more. know more, and perform better at work.

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Other Personality Insights

- Locus of Control

  "A personality attribute that measures the degree to which people believe they control their own fate"

  - Others believing that what happens to them in their lives is due to luck or chance.

- **Internal locus:** persons who believe that they control their own destiny.
- **External locus:** persons who believe that what happens to them is due to luck or chance (the uncontrollable effects of outside forces) .

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Other Personality Insights

- Employees can have two ways of thinking about control — **external** or **internal**.
- ➢ **Externals** believe that what happens to them is mostly due to **luck, other people, or outside forces**.
- They are usually **less satisfied** and **less involved** in their jobs.
- If they get a **bad performance review**, they might say, "My boss is unfair" or "My coworkers made me look bad."
- ➢ **Internals** believe that **their own actions** determine what happens.
- They take **responsibility** for their results.
- If they get a bad review, they might say, "I need to work harder or improve my skills."
- So, **internals** feel more in control and are often **happier and more motivated** at work.

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Other Personality Insights

- Machiavellianism (Mach)
  - *The degree to which an individual is pragmatic, maintains emotional distance, and seeks to gain and manipulate power—ends can justify means.*
  - Machiavellianism (Mach) means being practical, emotionally detached, and focused on achieving goals, even if it means using manipulation.
  - A person high in Machiavellianism believes that "**the end justifies the means**."
  - High-Mach people make good employees depends on the job: High productive in jobs bargaining skills or substantial rewards for excelling (such as a salesperson working on commission), like sales or purchasing

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Other Personality Insights (cont'd)

- Self-Esteem (SE)

  "The degree to which people like or dislike themselves"

  For example, self-esteem is directly related to expectations for success.

  - High SEs
    - Believe in themselves and expect success.
    - Take more risks and use unconventional approaches.
    - Are more satisfied with their jobs than Low SEs.
  - Low SEs :means a person doesn't feel very confident about themselves
    - They are easily influenced by others — they care a lot about what people think.
    - They depend on others' approval to feel good about themselves.

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Other Personality Insights (cont'd)

- Self-Monitoring
  - An individual's ability to adjust his or her behavior to external, situational factors.
  - High self-monitors:
    - Are sensitive to external cues and behave differently in different situations.
    - Can present contradictory public persona and private selves —impression management.
  - Low self-monitors
    - Do not adjust their behavior to the situation.
    - Are behaviorally consistent in public and private.

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- Risk-Taking
  - The propensity (or willingness) to take risks.
    - High risk-takers take less time and require less information than low risk-takers when making a decision.
    - For instance, in one study where managers worked on simulated exercises that required them to make hiring decisions, high risk-taking managers took less time to make decisions and used less information in making their choices than low risk-taking managers, the decision accuracy was the same for the two groups.
    - Organizational effectiveness (how well a company performs) is best when a manager's willingness to take risks matches the needs of their job.
    - Example: A manager in innovation or product development needs to take more risks to try new ideas. A manager in accounting or safety compliance should take fewer risks because mistakes can be costly.

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Emotions

- Emotions
  - Intense feelings (reactions) that are directed at specific objects (someone or something)
  - Universal emotions:
    - Anger
    - Fear
    - Sadness
    - Happiness
    - Disgust
    - Surprise

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Emotional Intelligence

- Emotional Intelligence (EI)
  - Emotional Intelligence (EI) is a set of skills that help a person handle challenges, pressure, and relationships successfully.
  - Dimensions of EI:
    - **Self-awareness**: The ability to be aware of what you're feeling.
    - **Self-management**: managing emotions and reactions
    - **Self-motivation**: Keeping yourself going even when things get hard.
    - **Empathy**: sensing how others are feeling
    - **Social skills**: handling the emotions of others

    Example: Resolving a conflict between coworkers calmly

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Implications for Managers

- Employee selection
- Helps in understanding employee behavior(s)
- By understanding others' behavior(s), can work better with them

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Understanding Personality Differences

- Personality-Job Fit Theory (Holland)
  - An employee's job satisfaction and likelihood of turnover depends on the compatibility of the employee's personality and occupation.
  - Holland's theory proposes that satisfaction is highest and turnover lowest when personality and occupation are compatible
  - Key points of the theory:
    - There are differences in personalities.
    - There are different types of jobs.
    - people in job environments compatible with their personality types should be more satisfied and less likely to resign voluntarily than people in incongruent jobs.

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Exhibit 15-4

Holland's Personality–Job Fit

Source: Based on J. L. Holland, *Making Vocational Choices: A Theory of Vocational Personalities and Work Environments* (Odessa, FL: Psychological Assessment Resources, 1997).

TYPE	PERSONALITY CHARACTERISTICS	SAMPLE OCCUPATIONS
Realistic. Prefers physical activities that require skill, strength, and coordination	Shy, genuine, persistent, stable, conforming, practical	Mechanic, drill press operator, assembly-line worker, farmer
Investigative. Prefers activities involving thinking, organizing, and understanding	Analytical, original, curious, independent	Biologist, economist, mathematician, news reporter
Social. Prefers activities that involve helping and developing others	Sociable, friendly, cooperative, understanding	Social worker, teacher, counselor, clinical psychologist
Conventional. Prefers rule-regulated, orderly, and unambiguous activities	Conforming, efficient, practical, unimaginative, inflexible	Accountant, corporate manager, bank teller, file clerk
Enterprising. Prefers verbal activities that offer opportunities to influence others and attain power	Self-confident, ambitious, energetic, domineering	Lawyer, real estate agent, public relations specialist, small business manager
Artistic. Prefers ambiguous and unsystematic activities that allow creative expression	Imaginative, disorderly, idealistic, emotional, impractical	Painter, musician, writer, interior decorator

Perception

- Perception
  - A process by which individuals give meaning (reality) to their environment by organizing and interpreting their sensory impressions.
  - Perception is how people understand and make sense of the world around them using their senses.
- Factors influencing perception:
  - Your own interests, biases, and expectations shape how you see things. Example: If you like a coworker, you may notice their good work more.
  - The target (what you're observing): How different, noticeable, or similar something is affects perception. Example: A bright red car stands out more than a gray car.
  - The situation (context) factors—place, time, location—draw attention or distract from the target.

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Exhibit 14.5 Perception Challenges: What Do You See?

Old woman or young woman?

A knight on a horse?

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How We Perceive People

- Attribution Theory
  - How the actions of individuals are perceived by others depends on what meaning (causation) we attribute to a given behavior.
    - **Attribution Theory** explains whether we think a person's actions are caused by themselves or by the situation
    - Internally caused behavior: under the individual's control
    - Externally caused behavior: due to outside factors
  - Determining the source of behaviors:
    - Distinctiveness: different behaviors in different situations
    - Consensus: behaviors similar to others in same situation
    - Consistency: regularity of the same behavior over time

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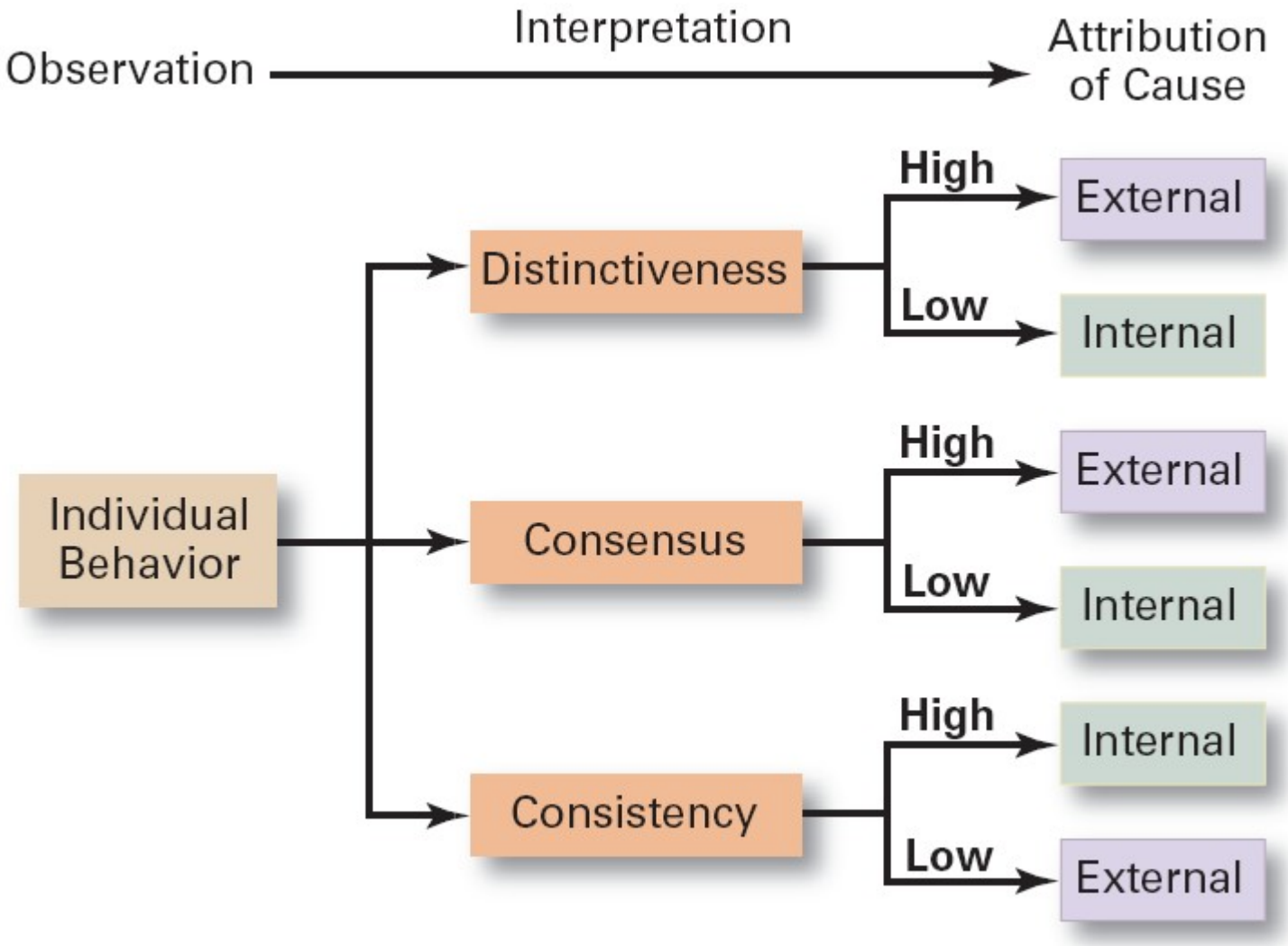
Exhibit 14.6 Attribution Theory



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How We Perceive People (cont'd)

- Attribution Theory – errors and biases (cont'd)
  - Fundamental attribution error
    - The tendency to underestimate the influence of external factors and to overestimate the influence of internal or personal factors.
  - Self-serving bias
    - The tendency of individuals to attribute their successes to internal factors while blaming personal failures on external factors.

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Shortcuts Used in Judging Others

- Assumed Similarity
  - Assuming that others are more like us than they actually are.
- Stereotyping
  - Judging someone on the basis of our perception of a group he or she is a part of.
- Halo Effect
  - Forming a general impression of a person on the basis of a single characteristic of that person

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Implications for Managers

- Employees react to perceptions
- Pay close attention to how employees perceive their jobs and management actions

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Learning

- Learning
  - Learning is a lasting change in behavior that happens because of experience.
    - Almost all complex behavior is learned.
    - Learning is a continuous, life-long process.
    - The principles of learning can be used to shape behavior
- Theories of learning:
  - Operant conditioning
  - Social learning

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Learning (cont'd)

- Operant Conditioning (B.F. Skinner)
  - The theory that behavior is a function of its consequences and is learned through experience.
  - People learn from the consequences of their actions.
  - Operant behavior: voluntary or learned behaviors
  - **Voluntary behaviors** are strengthened if rewarded and weakened if punished or ignored.
    - Behaviors are learned by making rewards contingent to behaviors.
    - Behavior that is rewarded (positively reinforced) is likely to be repeated. Reward: Giving a child a star for finishing homework → child does it again.
    - Behavior that is punished or ignored is less likely to be repeated Punishment: Scolding a child for bad behavior → less likely to repeat it.

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- Social Learning
  - The theory that individuals learn through their observations of others and through their direct experiences.
  - People learn by observing others and from their own experiences. A new employee learns proper customer service by watching a skilled coworker and seeing that polite behavior is praised.
  - Attributes of models that influence learning:
    - **Attentional:** the attractiveness or similarity of the model
    - **Retention:** how well the model can be recalled
    - **Motor reproduction:** the reproducibility of the model's actions
    - **Reinforcement:** the rewards associated with learning the model behavior

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Shaping: A Managerial Tool

- Shaping Behavior
  - Attempting to “mold” individuals by guiding their learning in graduated steps such that they learn to behave in ways that most benefit the organization.
  - Shaping methods:
    - **Positive reinforcement:** rewarding desired behaviors.
    - **Negative reinforcement:** removing an unpleasant consequence once the desired behavior is exhibited.
    - **Punishment:** penalizing an undesired behavior.
    - **Extinction:** eliminating a reinforcement for an undesired behavior.

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Contemporary Issues in OB

- Managing Generational Differences in the Workplace
  - Gen Y: individuals born after 1978
    - Bring new attitudes to the workplace that reflect wide arrays of experiences and opportunities
    - Want to work, but don't want work to be their life
    - Challenge the status quo
    - Have grown up with technology

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Exhibit 14.7 Gen Y Workers

Gen Y Workers

High Expectations of Self
They aim to work faster and better than other workers.

High Expectations of Employers
They want fair and direct managers who are highly engaged in their professional development.

Ongoing Learning
They seek out creative challenges and view colleagues as vast resources from whom to gain knowledge.

Immediate Responsibility
They want to make an important impact on Day 1.

Goal-Oriented
They want small goals with tight deadlines so they can build up ownership of tasks.

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Contemporary Issues in OB

- Managing Negative Behavior in the Workplace
  - Tolerating negative behavior sends the wrong message to other employees
  - Both preventive and responsive actions to negative behaviors are needed:
    - Screening potential employees
    - Responding immediately and decisively to unacceptable behavior
    - Paying attention to employee attitudes

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Terms to Know

- behavior
- organizational behavior
- employee productivity
- absenteeism
- turnover
- organizational citizenship behavior
- job satisfaction
- workplace misbehavior
- attitudes
- cognitive component
- affective component
- behavioral component
- job involvement
- organizational commitment
- perceived organizational support
- cognitive dissonance
- attitude surveys
- personality
- big-five model
- locus of control
- Machiavellianism

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Terms to Know (cont'd)

- self-esteem
- self-monitoring
- impression management
- emotions
- emotional intelligence (EI)
- perception
- attribution theory
- fundamental attribution error
- self-serving bias
- assumed similarity
- stereotyping
- halo effect
- learning
- operant conditioning
- social learning theory
- shaping behavior

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